masterstroke by TTP to have chosen an *Amir* who had the contacts and experience to use the strategic depth of Afghanistan to fall back in safety and fight back at will.

Nevertheless, in subsequent years, the military operation 'Zarb-e-Azb' created a substantial dent in the TTP rank and file. It seemed to be meeting the benchmark of weakening the terrorist group, as pointed out by Schmid (2011), that once 'terrorist groups fail to increase the number of civilian and security personnel fatalities in their attacks, or realise a decline in their ability to raise funds, inability to secure a safe haven for their headquarters or a corresponding increase in terrorist fatalities (including defections among leaders and members and the arrest, death or loss of a group's charismatic leader) weakening is detectable'.

WOULD TTP DIE AFTER THE US DEPARTURE FROM AFGHANISTAN?

The causes and processes of birth or inception are always distinctly different from those of death or end, whether of a man, an organisation or a nation. Some optimists thought that the TTP activities in Pakistan and its tribal areas would come to a halt after the US and NATO forces left Afghanistan. Their argument was that the TTP rose in reaction to the US invasion of Afghanistan and later on to protect the Al Qaeda and Taliban sanctuaries in FATA against the Pakistan forces. Therefore, it would evaporate once the situation changed. It was a grossly overstated hope.

TTP emulates Afghan Taliban in strategy and approach. As the morale of Afghan Taliban soared after the departure of a major chunk of the US and allied forces from Afghanistan, TTP's morale also swelled as it took cue from Afghan Taliban's strategy and approaches. TTP and the terrorist groups operating under its banner seem determined to continue to enjoy power and writ over their jurisdiction. They would keep their arms up and exert harder for their writ. Their focus has shifted to the demand for enforcement of *Sharia* in Pakistan.

Waliur Rehman, Deputy Commander of TTP, Mehsud Group, had stated that the main objective of their jihad was imposition of 'Sharia' in Pakistan and they would keep fighting until the Islamic Caliphate was established.[6] Later, the former TTP spokesperson Ehsanullah Ehsan said, 'Our fight with the Pakistani government would continue till the